Renovation of fortified underground complexes

The Galilee Medical Center

The Galilee Medical Center (GMC), a government hospital founded in 1956, is located in the city of Nahariya in Israel's Western Galilee. It is the only public medical center in the region and the second-largest hospital north of Tel Aviv. As the primary healthcare provider in northern Israel, GMC serves nearly one million residents—among them some of the country's most diverse populations.

With 69 departments and 800 hospital beds, the center is staffed by a team of over 3,400 dedicated professionals. It is also the region's largest employer and serves as the main teaching hospital of the Azrieli Faculty of Medicine at Bar-Ilan University in the Galilee, training approximately two-thirds of the medical students in northern Israel.

Strategically located just a few kilometers from the hostile Lebanese border, GMC is the closest hospital to any international border in Israel. This unique position places the center on the frontlines—both medically and nationally—demanding constant preparedness for emergencies, mass-casualty events, and complex trauma cases.
During the 2023–2024 "Iron Swords" war, the GMC operated continuously for 14 months under emergency protocols, much of the time in underground and fortified facilities. The hospital treated over 2,000 injured Israel Defense Forces (IDF) soldiers, many of whom suffered complex and life-threatening injuries. The conflict further exposed critical gaps in infrastructure, forcing a reduction from 777 to only 465 operational beds due to safety constraints.

Yet beyond its critical role in emergency response, the GMC is boldly stepping into the future as a center of **medical innovation and research:**

- **Regional Research Institute:** the GMC operates a growing clinical and translational research institute, fostering collaboration with academic institutions in Israel and abroad.

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Medical Center

- **Medical Innovation Center:** Winner of national innovation grants, this center is developing cutting-edge technologies and novel healthcare solutions—positioning the Galilee as a new frontier for medical excellence.
- **Vision for Expansion:** With a forward-looking agenda, the GMC envisions becoming a national model for equitable, state-of-the-art healthcare in the periphery, bridging the gap between center and north.

However, the hospital still faces systemic challenges. The Galilee ranks at the bottom of national averages in terms of hospital beds, intensive care capacity, and physicians per capita. After the war, returning evacuees from the north came to recognize the severe disparities in medical infrastructure compared to central Israel—and they are now demanding the healthcare equity they deserve.

At the same time, the region's rapidly aging population presents a growing healthcare challenge. Many of the patients admitted to GMC's internal medicine departments are elderly and coping with multiple chronic conditions. Among them are Holocaust survivors who require not only advanced medical treatment but also compassionate and dignified care. The hospital also treats a rising number of severely ill patients, whose complex medical needs place increasing demands on staff and facilities. To meet these challenges, the Galilee Medical Center is introducing advanced technologies for use in its internal medicine departments—enhancing quality of care, efficiency, and patient outcomes.

Friends of the Galilee Medical Center

The Friends of the Galilee Medical Center (NPO) work to promote the health of the Galilee's residents by developing the medical center, constructing new facilities, acquiring advanced technologies, strengthening ties with the community, raising awareness of healthy lifestyles, and creating a supportive healing environment in hospital wards and public spaces.

The organization operates in cooperation with the hospital's management to establish new departments, purchase state-of-the-art medical equipment, and introduce cutting-edge technologies — all with the goal of providing the best possible medical care to the residents of northern Israel.

Thanks to the generous support of donors from Israel and around the world, the Friends of the Galilee Medical Center are helping transform the hospital into a modern, pleasant, and up-to-date medical center that delivers high-quality care both in routine times and during emergencies.

In recent years, the organization has carried out several significant renovation projects and purchased advanced medical equipment. Currently, the association is engaged in fundraising for high-priority initiatives, including the renovation and upgrading of medical services and facilities — which will improve access to healthcare for a broader population in the region.

In addition, the organization seeks to strengthen the connection between the community and the medical center and raise awareness of healthy living through community outreach in partnership with local authorities and voluntary organizations across all sectors.

Renovation of two fortified underground complexes

The protected underground complexes are critically important for the Galilee Medical Center in Nahariya, which serves as the main hospital for the Western Galilee and operates in a region that frequently faces security threats.

During emergencies such as missile attacks or large-scale conflicts, hospitals must continue to provide uninterrupted medical care while ensuring the safety of patients, staff, and essential medical equipment. Fortified underground facilities allow key hospital departments to function safely even under direct threat, enabling the treatment of trauma patients, critically ill individuals, and vulnerable populations without interruption. These protected spaces also ensure the continuity of life-saving procedures, emergency surgeries, and intensive care services when above-ground areas may be unsafe.

Strengthening the hospital's underground protected complexes is therefore essential for maintaining medical resilience and safeguarding healthcare services for the entire region during times of crisis.

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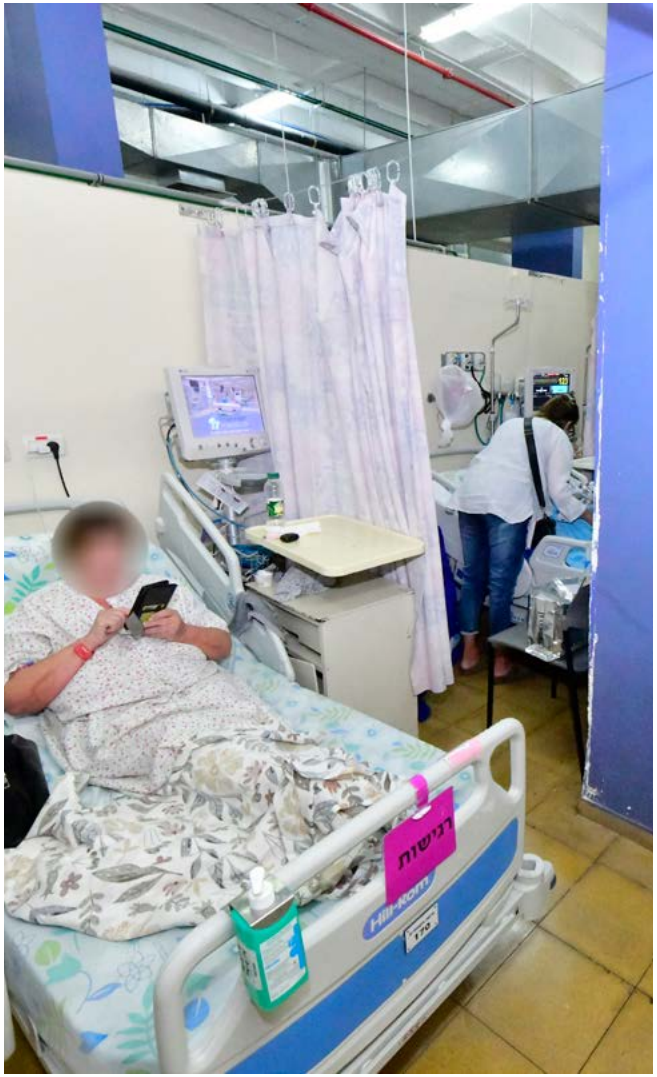
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The Need

The project includes the renovation and upgrading of two protected underground hospital complexes designed to ensure continuity of medical care during emergencies. The renovation will include the replacement and upgrading of ceilings, floors, and flooring, installation of medical furniture, nurses' stations, modern lighting, and fully equipped sanitary facilities including toilets, showers, and changing rooms. The complexes will also include dedicated areas such as a physiotherapy corner and medication rooms, as well as antibacterial wall coverings to maintain the highest standards of hygiene and infection control.

providing safe and functional medical environments during times of crisis.

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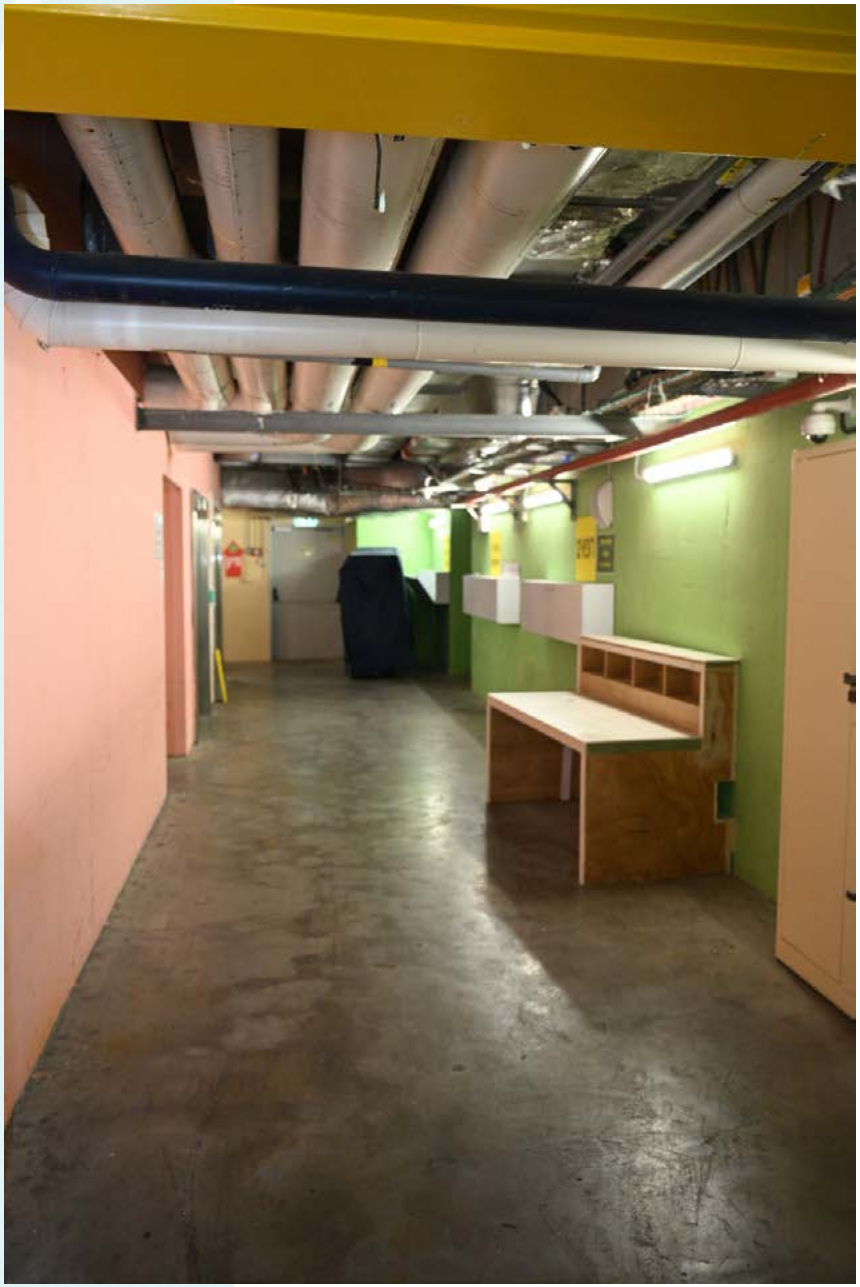
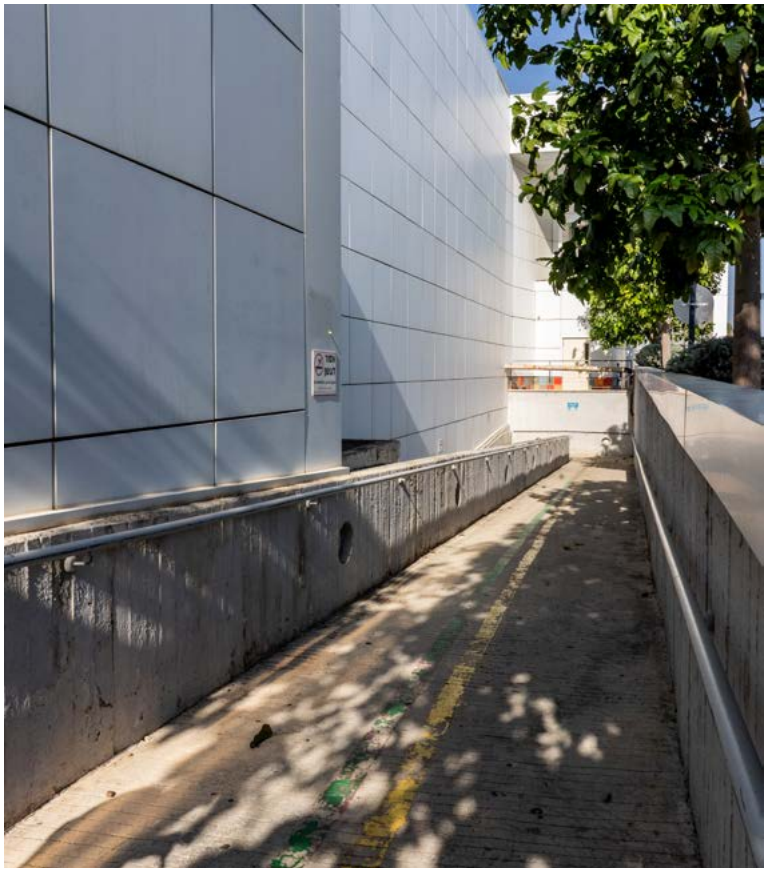
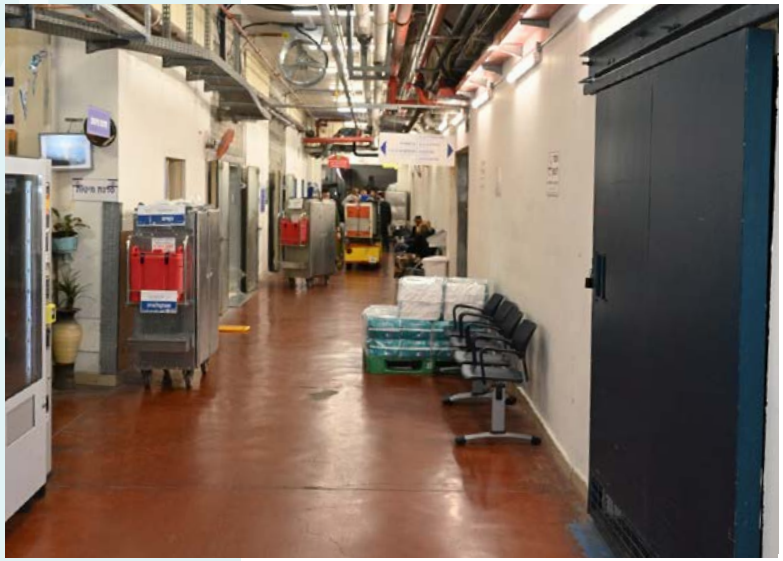


The Cost

One complex, with an **estimated cost of $3 million**, will accommodate up to 110 people.

Second complex, **estimated at $2 million**, will accommodate approximately 80 people.





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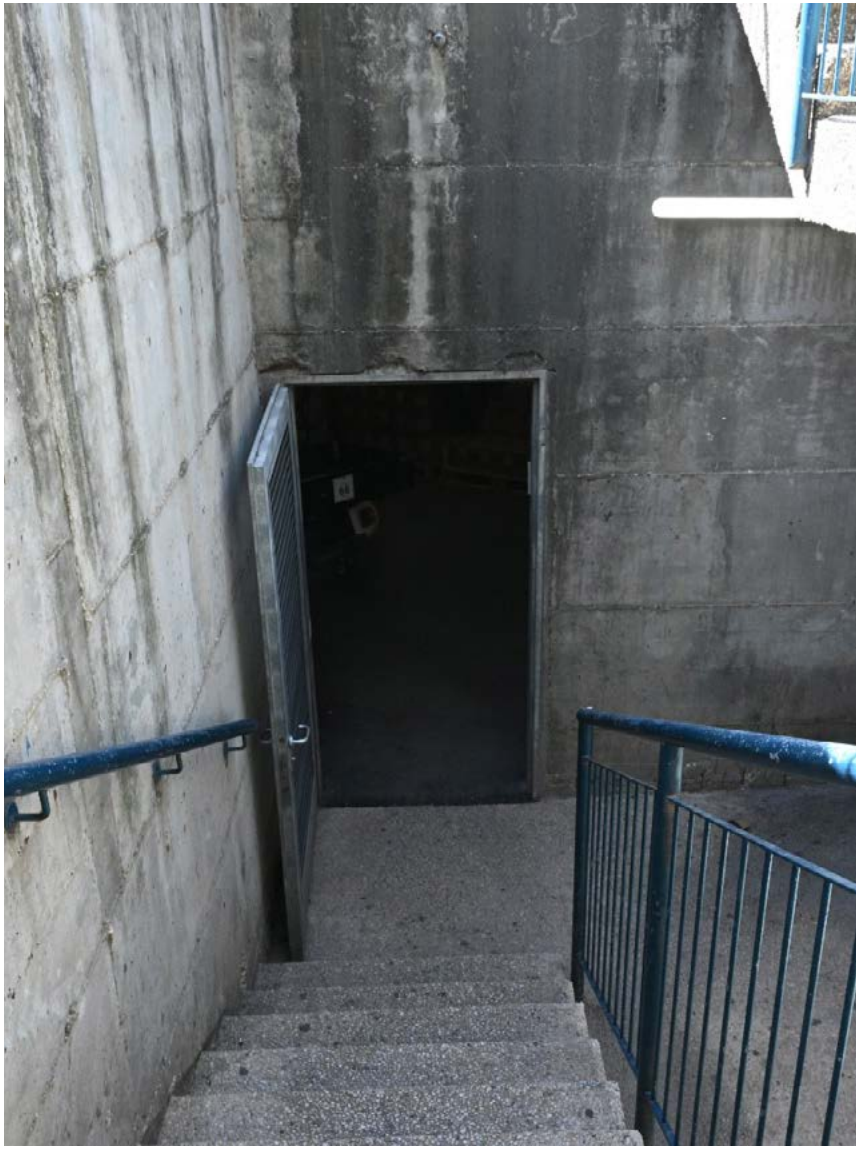

Galilee Medical Center

Friends Of Galilee Medical Center

עמותת הידידים
המרכז הרפואי לגליל

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